

a serious run for their money in the camera department. Now, these cameras are not the absolute best in the overall smartphone market. But what this does mean is that OPPO is currently leading in the flip phone camera space by providing users with the most versatile camera setup you can get in this segment.

The primary camera clicks some stellar shots in both daylight and low-light conditions. The dynamic range is impressive, the detail retention is great, and colours look nice and vivid. Photos taken on default settings are good enough to be shared on social media instantly. Close-up shots have a bit of fringing, but it's not a deal-breaker. 2x telephoto shots provide impressive results as well with astoundingly good colour consistency between the two lenses.

As for portrait images, when I first tried it out, the phone would falter in tricky lighting situations and create a weird sort of halo around the subject. Since then, OPPO has pushed an update which has almost solved this issue. There are still slight remnants of it in really tricky lighting but it's not nearly as jarring as before. Portrait images as a whole could be tuned a bit better. Additionally, the edge detection isn't the best we've seen. Still, for the average consumer, the portrait images and perfectly serviceable and the 2x portrait shots look particularly aesthetic.

The ultrawide lens takes excellent images – you get minimal barrel distortion, plenty of detail, and vibrant colours. You can also shoot macro images, and the results are quite pleasing and detailed.

As for selfies, while it shoots decent selfies, there's no reason to actually use this lens when you rather be clicking supremely detailed selfies using the main camera via the cover screen.

PERFORMANCE

So far, the OPPO Find N3 Flip outclasses the market leader – the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 – in two key areas. Cameras and visibility of the crease. The Samsung also claps back with superior cover screen functionality (using Samsung's Good Lock app). And in the performance section, once again, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 proves

to be superior to the Find N3 Flip. At least, when it comes to synthetic benchmarks.

Let me start with synthetic benchmarks. Be it AnTuTu, GeekBench, or PCMark Work, the OPPO Find N3 Flip gets left in the dust by its two main competitors – the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 and Razr 40 Ultra. The same pattern repeats itself in GPU benchmarks, with the Find N3 Flip lagging behind in almost every test.

I suspected some throttling going on since previous phones we've tested with the Dimensity 9200 SoC came back with significantly better results. I ran the CPU Throttling Test to confirm this and upon starting off the test, I immediately saw that the cores were not running at their maximum clock speed. Even with throttled performance from the get-go, the phone further throttled down by another 32 per cent. OPPO could have done this to avoid overheating and lag, but it does hurt the end consumer in a small way where they may be expecting flagship-grade performance but won't quite get it.

In day-to-day operations, I faced some unexpected stutters and lag as well which I'm not usually used to seeing on phones with flagship processors. Casual users aren't really going to notice these minute stutters though. The gaming experience is decent, but not as smooth sailing as other flip phones. The software is decent – you get low bloatware. OPPO is also providing 3 years of OS updates and 5 years of security patches, which is pretty good.

All in all, this is definitely not the most powerful flip smartphone on the market, but for users who value cameras over performance – what you get here in terms of power is not bad at all.

BATTERY

The OPPO Find N3 Flip houses the largest battery on a Flip phone. It outclasses both the Moto Razr 40 Ultra and Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 with its massive 4,300 mAh battery capacity. Couple this with the power-efficient MediaTek Dimensity 9200 SoC (and the fact that OPPO is throttling the performance) and you've got the best battery life we've experienced on a flip phone. The phone easily provides 8-9 hours of on-screen time with regular usage and

the battery drains minimally in standby mode. In our 4K video loop test, the phone lasted a whopping 16 hours and 12 minutes before dying on us. This is longer than normal candybar form factor phones such as the Vivo X90 Pro! The charging speeds are one of the fastest as well. The phone charged from 0 to 100 per cent in merely 61 minutes, which is pretty impressive. Sadly, there's no wireless charging support.

VERDICT

So, is the OPPO Find N3 Flip the best flip smartphone on the market? The answer, unfortunately, cannot be summed down to one word. The Find N3 Flip blows the competition out of the water in multiple key areas including camera versatility, battery life, and fast charging. It is undoubtedly better than the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 and the Moto Razr 40 Ultra here.

Then, there are some areas where it sits in the middle of the pack such as foldable UI, software updates, and display quality. Finally, there is one important area where it lags behind considerably – performance. The SoC inside the phone is being held back from reaching its full potential, allowing competitors to smoke it in terms of raw performance.

So, performance junkies would probably be better off choosing the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 or the Moto Razr 40 Ultra – both of which are smoother and faster. However, if you can live with slightly underwhelming performance, the OPPO Find N3 Flip will absolutely delight you.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Dimensity 9200 (4 nm) | RAM: 12 GB LPDDR5X | Storage: 256 GB UFS 4.0 | OS: ColorOS 13.2 based on Android 13 | Thickness: 7.79 mm (unfolded), 16.45 mm (folded) | Weight: 198 g | Main display: 6.8-inch LTPO AMOLED, 120 Hz, 2520 x 1080 pixels, HDR10+ | Cover display: 3.26-inch AMOLED, 720 x 382 pixels | Glass protection: Gorilla Glass Victus | Rear cameras: 50 MP primary + 48 MP ultrawide + 32 MP telephoto | Selfie camera (inner screen): 32 MP | Battery capacity: 4,300 mAh | Charging: 44 W SUPERVOOC, 80 W charger incl. | Audio: Dual speakers, Dolby Atmos

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